

Linux Foundation launches the Dronecode Project

The Linux Foundation has launched a project that will develop open source software to enable non-military unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs), popularly known as drones. Called the Dronecode Project, it was launched on October 13 at the Linux Conference in Dusseldorf, Germany. With this project, a new member has been added to the Foundation's Collaboration Projects initiative, which brings together best practices in technology to develop open source codes.



The Dronecode Project will also join the Yocto Project in order to build embedded Linux platforms. The project is based on APM UAV software and code, which are hosted by the project's co-founding member, 3D Robotics. Other founding members are Box, DroneDeploy and jDrones. Dronecode will help in data analysis, storage and in the displays for drones.

Drones are quite commonly used nowadays, courtesy the unending automated wars in Iraq, Pakistan and Afghanistan. The project will be headed by rsync author and Samba co-lead Andrew Tridgell, who is also the lead maintainer in the development of APM. Executive director of the Linux Foundation, Jim Zemlin told eWEEK, that potential synergies are present between Dronecode and the Yocto Project. Along with the APM UAV application code, the Dronecode Project also includes the PX4 project code. Zemlin is pretty confident about the Dronecode Project.

the security improvements in Linux 3.17. The new release includes file sealing protection.

Another German city abandons Windows to adopt Linux at its administrative offices

Germany is known for being an early adopter of open source software. Munich city completely adopted open source technology quite a while ago. And now, government offices in the city of Gummersbach have reportedly switched to open source technology. Gummersbach is a small city compared to Munich, with a population of barely 50,000. The administration considered switching to open source technology in 2007



and started the migration process back then. Over 300 PCs in the administrative offices of Gummersbach have adopted the SUSE Linux operating system. The city's representative confirmed that Linux has replaced the Windows XP OS on these PCs. The official announcement of this migration has been published on the European Commission's website. It will take a long time to replace Windows entirely, but it's a good initiative. We might see more cities in Germany soon follow suit. There is no doubt that this action will increase the popularity of Linux in Germany amongst citizens also.

Demand for Linux Foundation certification increases!

According to a recent study, the demand for Linux jobs continues to increase. According to a recent report by Dice, 93 per cent of employers are looking to hire Linux professionals. The best way to increase the probability of getting a Linux job is to clear the Linux Foundation's certification exams. As of now, Linux Foundation (LF) has two attractive certification programmes - Certified SysAdmin (LFCS) and Certified Engineer (LFCE). Linux Foundation's certification exams are one level higher than the Linux



Professional Institute (LPI) certifications. The former are designed to be as high level as Red Hat Certified System Administrator (RHCSA) and are not easy to pass. The success rate of these exams is below 60 per cent but they are highly recommended by those who have already taken them. The exams are held from a Linux shell. There are online guides that help you succeed in LF certification exams. A free preparation guide is available on Linux Foundation's website as well.

Red Hat Enterprise Linux 6.6 released

Red Hat, a provider of open source solutions, has released the latest version of the Red Hat Enterprise Linux 6 (RHEL) platform, version 6.6. Users of the newer RHEL 7 will also be allowed to run RHEL 6 apps in a container. RHEL 6 was launched in 2010, and the latest release offers a stable and secure foundation, enabling organisations to build infrastructure according to business requirements through better flexibility. In June this year, Red Hat had launched